STUDENTSPEAK

> "The NLSIU has revamped its PhD programme. The research advisory committees are comparable to a first-class international doctoral programme. I also get an opportunity to offer electives closely related to my research interests"



VARSHA AITHALA, LAWYER BY TRAINING, CURRENTLY A PHD SCHOLAR

TOP 5

UNIVERSITIES WITH MAXIMUM VICTORIES IN INTER-UNIVERSITY MOOT COURT COMPETITIONS

RANK	UNIVERSITY	COMPETITIONS WON
1	DR. RAM MANOHAR LOHIYA NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, LUCKNOW	25
2	GUJARAT NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, GANDHINAGAR	24
3	CHANAKYA NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, PATNA	16
4	NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY ODISHA, CUTTACK	10
5	THE NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF ADVANCED LEGAL STUDIES, KOCHI	6

Note: For AY 2021-22

TOP 5

UNIVERSITIES WITH BEST FACULTY-STUDENT RATIO

RANK	UNIVERSITY	RATIO
1	GUJARAT NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, GANDHINAGAR	1.58
2	NATIONAL LAW SCHOOL OF INDIA UNIVERSITY, BENGALURU	1.49
3	NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY ODISHA, CUTTACK	1.18
4	DR. RAM MANOHAR LOHIYA NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, LUCKNOW	1.07
5	THE NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF ADVANCED LEGAL STUDIES, KOCHI	0.93

Note: Only LLM student count was taken to calculate the ratio

sity's registrar. Historically, attracting the best, especially in the field of law, has been a major challenge for any law institute, he points out. But, fortunately, there has been a trend-reversal with academicians—having done their PhDs from leading universities in the UK and the USA—opting to return to India to pursue career opportunities here. "That helps us get people who are doing cutting-edge research in their respective fields."

According to Nuggehalli, there are two areas the institute is focusing on to make a larger impact. "We want to keep pushing the pedal on student outcomes. With the increased numbers, and therefore increased diversity in various student interests, we should be able to get a cohort that can excel in various areas," he says. This will ensure that the NLSIU graduates contribute not just in the traditional legal practice fields like litigation but also in other associated avenues, such as policy think tanks and civil society organisations. Alongside this, the institute has identified a few clusters for research—including fields such as legal system reform, environment, labour and intellectual property—based on its resources and also from the point of view of what the country needs at this point in time. "Now that we have an increased faculty strength, we are actively encouraging research clusters. The clusters will work together to encourage both interventions and publications in these areas," says Nuggehalli. This is important, he adds, if the university wants to go up the rankings, both in Asia and in the world. ■